

Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς

Alexander of Aphrodisias and the Aristotelian Commentary Tradition

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Period: *Ῥωμαϊκή* [Roman](#)
Dialect: *Κοινή φιλοσοφική* [Philosophical Koine](#)
Domain: *Φιλοσοφία* [Philosophy](#)
Format: *Πραγματεία* [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Aristotelian](#)

Alexander of Aphrodisias was a Greek philosopher who lived and worked in the late second and early third centuries CE. He originated from the city of Aphrodisias in Asia Minor but moved to Athens, where he held the officially appointed chair in Aristotelian philosophy. He dedicated this position to the emperors Septimius Severus and Caracalla.

A leading figure in the Peripatetic school, Alexander served primarily as a commentator and defender of Aristotle's works, earning him the ancient nickname "the Commentator." His surviving writings include detailed commentaries on several of Aristotle's texts, such as the **Prior Analytics**, **Topics**, and **Metaphysics**. He also authored independent philosophical treatises, the most famous being **On Fate**, which argues against Stoic determinism, and **On the Soul**.

Modern scholars regard Alexander as the most important interpreter of Aristotle from antiquity. His clear explanations aimed to systematize Aristotle's thought and to argue against rival schools like Stoicism and Platonism. His theory of the intellect, which distinguished between the human mind and a divine active intellect, was especially influential. This idea profoundly shaped later medieval philosophy in both the Islamic world and Latin Europe. For centuries, his commentaries were essential guides for the study of Aristotle.

Works (16)

- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς τὸν Ἀριστοτέλην ἐν Ἑλληνικοῖς · [Commentaries-Aristotle in Greek](#) · 173 passages
- Ἠθικὰ προβλήματα · [Ethical Problems](#) · 47 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τοῦ Ἀριστοτελικοῦ Νοῦ · [Fragments on Aristotelian Intellect](#) · 18 passages
- Εἰς τὰ Μετὰ τὰ Φυσικὰ Ἀριστοτέλους Ὑπομνήματα · [On Aristotle's Metaphysics, Commentary](#) · 837 passages
- Εἰς τὰ Μετεωρολογικὰ Βιβλία Ἀριστοτέλους · [On Aristotle's Meteorology Books, Commentary](#) · 227 passages
- Εἰς τὸ Πρῶτον Βιβλίον Ἀναλυτικῶν Προτέρων · [On Aristotle's Prior Analytics Book I. Commentary](#) · 417 passages
- Εἰς τὰ Ὀκτὼ Βιβλία Τοπικῶν Ἀριστοτέλους Ὑπομνήματα · [On Aristotle's Topics Books Eight, Commentary](#) · 591 passages
- Περὶ Εἰμαρμένης · [On Fate](#) · 49 passages
- Περὶ Πυρετῶν · [On Fevers](#) · 80 passages
- Περὶ Μίξεως · [On Mixture](#) · 26 passages

- Εἰς τὰ Ἀναλυτικὰ Ὑστερα Ἀποσπάσματα Ὑπομνημάτων · On the Posterior Analytics, Commentary Fragments · 4 passages
- Περὶ Ψυχῆς · On the Soul · 100 passages
- Περὶ Ψυχῆς · On the Soul, Supplementary Books · 86 passages
- Προβλήματα · Problems, Books 1–2 · 196 passages
- Προβλήματα · Problems, Books 3–4 · 183 passages
- Ἀπορίαι καὶ λύσεις · Questions · 41 passages

Other Aristotelian Authors

- Ἀνώνυμος εἰς τὰς Κατηγορίας τοῦ Ἀριστοτέλους · Anonymous Commentary on Aristotle · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ἐν Ἠθικοῖς Νικομαχείοις · Anonymous Commentary on Aristotle · 3 works
- Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς · Apollonius of Aphrodisias · 1 work
- Ἀριστοτέλης · Aristotle · 56 works
- Ἀνώνυμος Ἀριστοτέλους Σοφιστικῶν Ἐλέγχων · Sophistical Refutations Anonymous · 6 works